



MONTHLY UPDATE

Liberia: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-17 · 27 systems and instruments tracked, 8 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-17 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

July 2026 was organised around the Liberia Technology Summit of 21-22 July, at which the President made the whole-of-government digital office the centre of the agenda and the telecoms ministry named four builds – a national digital addressing system, a second subsea cable, expanded fibre and a national data centre – none of them dated or costed. In the same weeks the telecoms regulator revoked an operator's licence, refused to publish its own revenue and became the subject of a corruption complaint; the African Development Bank launched a six-year country strategy with no digital sector in it; and the first figures were published for the e-procurement platform and the interoperable payment fee schedule.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

The regulator revoked [Starcell International Liberia's universal licence and spectrum authorisation with immediate effect on 22 July 2026](#), after a 90-day suspension from 9 February during which no corrective action was taken; spectrum, numbering resources and regulatory privileges revert to the Authority. The grounds cited were failure to commence operations, unmet financial obligations and non-payment of universal access contributions.

At the same 21 July event, the Posts and Telecommunications Minister [announced a second subsea cable and expanded fibre](#), with no completion date, budget line or cable landing partner given for either; the LTA separately said it is reviewing a World Bank-supported report on reducing telecom costs.

The Anti-Corruption Commission's 30 July complaint over the telecoms traffic-monitoring arrangement, forwarded to its investigation unit, is covered under Governance and regulation → Public debate and participation in policymaking below.

Data Storage

At the same 21 July event the minister also [announced a national data centre to hold government data domestically](#), with no completion date, budget line or site given.

Cybersecurity

The Cybercrime Act 2025 [had still not received presidential signature as of 1 July](#), nearly six months after the Senate's concurrence cleared its passage through the Legislature. The full text the base holds is the 2021 base bill, which carries none of the 2025 provisions.

Digital public infrastructure

Digital Payments and Fintech

The central bank's fee schedule for interoperable transfers was reported on 5 August: [1.0% of value from US\\$1.00 to US\\$2,000.00 and a flat US\\$25.00 above that, available 24 hours a day](#). The flat cap falls below 1.0% of value above about US\$2,500 and keeps falling.

On 28 July the finance minister named the [national electronic payment switch as the enabler of a 24-hour economy, with creative-sector support to enter the 2027 budget](#). No go-live date was given.

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

Speaking on 21 July, the Posts and Telecommunications Minister said [rollout of a national digital postal address system had begun across all fifteen counties](#), with no completion date or budget line given.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The e-procurement platform published its first operating figures on 5 August: [more than 1,200 vendors registered and more than US\\$400,000 in revenue generated](#). No contract value transacted, tender count, bidder numbers or share of government procurement passing through the platform is given. Two days later it became an export: Sierra Leone's procurement authority [sent a delegation to Monrovia on 6-7 August to study the implementation](#), where the executive director dated the national launch to February 2025 after a six-institution pilot and credited the African Development Bank and the World Bank with the backing behind it. A later account of the same visit [records the telecommunications regulator receiving equipment to strengthen its own use of the platform](#), framed as deepening bilateral cooperation on digital transformation and procurement transparency.

Licensing moved off paper in the same week. The telecommunications regulator [put an automated telecom licensing and renewal platform into service](#), letting applicants apply and renew online while keeping in-person service available. No licence count, processing time or fee schedule is published.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

The same package, [set out on 17 July](#), covers a split of infrastructure and service licences with rural incentives, tower-sharing rules, the country's first satellite regulations, an IMEI anti-theft regime and repatriation of the .lr country domain. None has been published as an instrument.

Strategies, plans and policies

The African Development Bank launched its [country strategy for 2026-2031 in Monrovia](#) on 30 July, cutting its sectors from four to three and funding an indicative 2026-2028 programme of UA 129m — US\$172.86m at the [February 2026 conversion](#) — of which 36.3% is unfunded. The only digital line in the indicative programme is a non-lending study on digital solutions for Monrovia traffic congestion, and the strategy's own ICT assessment cites a policy that expired in 2024.

Regional collaboration

At the African Telecommunications Union plenipotentiary session in Abuja in July, Liberia [negotiated a waiver of US\\$361,151.36 in arrears dating back to 1982](#), deposited its instrument of ratification and had its voting rights restored.

Data protection

The telecoms regulator [fined an operator LRD 4m for issuing a subscriber's SIM to a third party without authorisation](#). The penalty came under telecoms powers rather than data-protection law — which is the point, since the Act that would have supplied the latter is unsigned.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

On 30 July the Anti-Corruption Commission [confirmed it had forwarded a complaint about the telecoms traffic-monitoring arrangement to its investigation unit](#). No evidence has been publicly produced and no findings made.

Open data

The telecoms regulator's chairman declined at a 30 July press briefing to disclose the Authority's revenue, [saying he reports to the President](#). The Authority publishes industry data — its 2025 mid-year report puts the two operators' combined revenue at US\$96.1m for the first half of 2025 against US\$79.8m a year earlier — but its own licensing fees, spectrum charges, levies and numbering receipts remain unpublished as at 4 August 2026.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

At the President's third national youth town hall in Buchanan on 29 July, the President's Youth Advisory Council called for artificial intelligence to be made a national priority through education frameworks, innovation and fabrication laboratories and skills provision. The President [did not dismiss it and conditioned support on applications in agriculture, transport and commerce; no policy, institution, budget line or date followed](#).

The country's first working legal AI was launched on 31 July: [CJ Lewis, built by the law library Liblaw over Supreme Court opinions from 1861 to 2026 plus statutes and regulations, with OHCHR support on human-rights principles in the design](#). No accuracy or evaluation figure is given, no model or vendor is named, and the corpus is a private compilation.

ICT Industry

The port authority signed a [non-exclusive smart-ports memorandum with HAROPA PORT](#) covering all four seaports, [with no amount, date or named system](#).

Innovation ecosystem

The technology summit closed on 22 July with a [Monrovia cybersecurity firm winning the national Startup World Cup on a domestic-data-custody pitch](#).

UNDP set out its contributions at the summit, adding in its own account of 3 August that its innovation hub sits under its Africa innovation platform.

Inclusion and capacity

Access to services

No later figure for account ownership or mobile wallet holding has been published. The base's position rests on the [account of digital finance expansion of 13 July](#), which carries no measurement of its own.

Literacy

On 31 July, 19 young leaders took the [first of three media and information literacy sessions in Monrovia](#), run through [the UN electoral support project with the National Elections Commission and the Press Union on Canadian funding](#). Six external funders and implementers stand behind a programme whose stated purpose is national resilience against misinformation before elections, and no budget figure is disclosed for it.

Training and skills

UNDP also [announced a partnership with the University of Liberia to establish the country's first master's degree in artificial intelligence](#), with no commitment amount disclosed.

Finance

New investments

The finance minister put the youth entrepreneurship investment bank at [almost US\\$18m targeting 30,000 youth-led businesses and about 100,000 jobs](#), with a national coordinator recruited and a board being constituted. No disbursement is stated.

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